

SRG

USHBC INGREDIENT INNOVATION

MARCH 2021



ON THE MENU

01: INTRODUCTIONS (12-12:15pm)

02: OVERVIEW (12:15-12:30)

03: CONCEPT PRESENTATION (12:30-1:15)

04: BREAK (1:15-1:30)

05: CONCEPT PRESENTATION (1:30-2:15)

06: TOP TAKEAWAYS (2:15-2:30)

07: PANEL (2:30-2:45)

08: DISTILLATION (2:45-3:00)

THE OPPORTUNITY

- Develop new ingredient protocepts that inspire manufacturers to develop products with blueberry ingredients for retail use.
- Appeal to a new generation of consumers looking for natural ingredients, clean labels and underscore the value and superiority of REAL blueberry ingredients.
- Consider the potential in health and wellness balanced with bakery and indulgence.

THE OUTCOME

- Leverage these protocepts throughout the program to inspire manufacturers
- Incorporate ideas into:
  - Final ‘sales tool’ collateral piece, available both online and in print
  - Advertising assets
  - Webinar content and culinary demos

USHBC INNOVATION

OUR CHALLENGE

- Ideate concepts on paper for each category, trying to use a variety of blueberry formats
- Uncover new/innovative functional benefits to using blueberry ingredients
- After paper concepts are narrowed down, 15 total formulations developed

PRODUCT FOCUS

- Snacking (sweet or savory)
- Bakery / Baked Goods / Confectionery
- Cereals / Snack Bars
- Beverages
  - Nonalcoholic
- Prepared Foods-all dayparts (fresh/frozen)
- Sauces / Marinades / Jams / Jellies
- Wildcard Platform

TARGET AUDIENCE

Ingredient manufacturers (primarily R&D, marketing) within snacking, bakery, cereal, beverage and prepared foods sectors

CULINARY STRATEGY CONSIDERATIONS

Culinary Trend Drivers:

EATING OPTIMIZED

Functional foods for health, wellness and longevity

UNABASHED FOOD SATISFACTION

Foods, formats, and flavors to be unabashedly enjoyed

APPETITES FOR EXPLORATION

Foods that celebrate and explore flavors and formats from around the world

CULINARY CONVENIENCE CULTURE

Foods for convenience and customization, without compromise

TARGET AUDIENCE EXAMPLES

General Mills

CONAGRA BRANDS



BOBO'S

OUR APPROACH



	PHASE 1:	PHASE 2:	PHASE 3:
PURPOSE:	Ideate concepts that utilize a variety of blueberry ingredient formats that inspire CPG manufacturers to use blueberries in new and innovative ways.	Distill down ideas on paper in order to choose top relevant concepts for USHBC. Develop full formulations to be evaluated for photography and collateral needs.	Evaluate formulations in order to select final concepts to move forward into photography and collateral/sales tool development.
DELIVERABLES:	• 150+ ideas on paper	• 15 developed formulations	• 10-12 final formulation selects

TREND DRIVERS: PRIORITIZATION

For USHBC Ingredient Innovation, we have prioritized four culinary drivers that we believe will provide the strongest dig sites for innovation and inspiration. These drivers are anchored in the cultural and culinary truths that are driving forward food trends that provide a rich opportunity for blueberries in various formats.

EATING OPTIMIZED

Functional foods for health, wellness and longevity



UNABASHED FOOD SATISFACTION

Foods, formats, and flavors to be unabashedly enjoyed



APPETITES FOR EXPLORATION

Foods that celebrate and explore flavors and formats from around the world



CULINARY CONVENIENCE CULTURE

Foods for convenience and customization, without compromise



MARKETPLACE MANIFESTATIONS

EATING OPTIMIZED



FOOD TRIBE FAVORITES

Gluten-free, dairy-free, keto, paleo, Whole-30…these are no longer fringe foodie interests but growing groups of consumers making conscious food choices and food "rules" that are setting the standards for mainstream wholesome eating.

UNABASHED FOOD SATISFACTION



COMFORT CLASSICS

Homemade, homestyle, and "old school" bakery favorites are returning to the spotlight, showcasing that sometimes simple is sensational, and the past isn't totally forgotten. And with ingredients that make these heritage eats more permissible in today's landscape? That's a win-win.

APPETITES FOR EXPLORATION



FINISHING TOUCH FLAVOR

Globally-inspired sauces, condiments, seasonings and dressings are an easy way to add exploration and intrigue to familiar dishes for an accessible sense of discovery. With a broad range of applicability from rubs and marinades to finishing touch sauces and dips, globally-inspired condiments are highly sought after.

CULINARY CONVENIENCE CULTURE



CREATIVE KITS

From the reinvigoration of grocery store stalwarts like salad kits to modern-day stars like retail and DTC complete meal kits, speed-scratch solutions that make layered, dynamic and delicious meals easy and accessible shine in today's time-strapped, efficiency-oriented food culture.



IDEATION

We generated over **150** ideas across **7** platforms to meet the goals of the brief.

IDEATION RESULTS

BEVERAGES	BAKERY/CONFECTIONS	CEREALS/SNACK BARS	PREPARED FOODS	SAUCES/JAMS/MARINADES	SNACKS	WILDCARD
Blueberry Boost	Blueberry brioche toasts	Collagen Pops	Cheesecake bites	Superfood Nut Butters	Blueberry and Greek Yoghurt Shoots	Blueberry crumble ice cream
Blueberry Botanical Gin Mixers	Blueberry Upside Down Mini Cakes	Blue Pemmi	Kids turkey and blueberry meatballs	Spicy Blue Rub	Infused Fruits	Blue Super Squeeze
Immunity and Vitamin Shots	Blueberry and Roasted White Chocolate Croissants	Blueberry Coconut Mochi Snack Bar	Pancake bacon	Blueberry and Preserved Lemon Relish	Blueberry Dusted Nut Mix	
Blueberry Superfood Smoothie Cubes	Blue Berry Pot du Creme	Blueberry Dusted Lemon Ginger Oat Bar	Sticky Sesame Blue Wings	Non Dairy Blueberry Toast Toppers	Sour Snacks	Blue Chimis
Spicy Blue Mule	Blue All the Way Mochi Cake Mix	Blue & Gold Overnight Oat Bars	Creamy Blue Tamales	Blueberry, Chia, and Honeysuckle Jam	Blueberry Stuffed Cheese sticks	Blueberry and Lavendar Affogato
Blue Nitro Creamy Cold Brew (Cold Brewberry)	Blueberry Allspice Rolls	Power Berry Cereal fortified with Blueberry Fiber	Sweet and Savory Blueberry Corn Pudding Souffle	Blueberry and Charred Red Onion Chutney	Super corn	Blueberry Triple Cream Brie
Blue Green Tea "Boba"	Blueberry Babka	Blueberry Chocolate Caffeinated Energy Bar	Blueberry Lamb Picadillo	Blueberry Vinegar Salad Dressing	Cultured Blueberry Coconut Chia Seed Plant Based Yogurt	Dried Blueberry with sharp Cheddar
Blueberry Vinegar Shrub- Lime and Bay Leaf	Blueberry Scallion and Lox Scone	Blueberry Balsamic Macaron	Dried Blueberry, almond, and caper cous cous	Blueberry Tarragon Mustard	Tea Infused Dried Blueberries	Dried Blueberry / black pepper for grinding
Gin and Blueberry Juice Based Cocktails in a Can	Triple Blueberry Muffin Cake Pops	Super blue grain-free granola	Blueberry, Balsamic, and Ricotta Spread	Pickled Blueberry Steak Sauce	Lavender Cookies with Crunchy Peanut Butter and Blueberry Jam	Antioxidant Rich Dog Treats
Blueberry Vanilla Chocolate Bomb	Blueberry Rhubarb Extruded Cookie	Blue Cripsy Rice Treat Bars	Blueberry and baby mozzarella "caprese"	Blueberry and Roasted Habanero Salsa	Chocolate coated Frozen Blueberry Banana Bites	Pickled cocktail garnish
Blue Antioxidant Latte	Blueberry Halva	Blueberry Basil Oat Bar Bakes	Blueberry BBQ Seitan "Ribs"	Smokey Blue Hot Sauce	Blueberry, Riesling, and Wild Boar snack stick	Wild Blueberry Gravlax
Blueberry Whip Lemonade	Blueberry Scone in Earl Grey Ice Cream	Blueberry Yogurt Bar	Frozen Blueberry and Cheese Sandwich	Blueberry, Thyme and Lemon Mostarda	Blueberry Biltong	Chill Blues-(Blueberry CBD Gummnies)
Blueberry Milkshake in a nitro can	Blueberry Cornbread Cobbler Ice Cream	PB & B Bar	Frozen Blueberry Pancake Breakfast "Pudding"	Blueberry Mint and Portwine Jelly	Dried Blueberry, banana, maple, and pistachio trail mix	Blueberry Mousse Bombes
Blueberry Hot White Chocolate	Plant Based Almond Flour Blueberry Breakfast Biscuits	Blueberry Crisp Blondie Bar	Blueberry Pork Sausage Sandwich	Blueberry Balsamic Glaze	Dried Blueberry, arugula chips, and radish chips with goat "moon" cheese	blueberry and red onion pickles
Blueberry Rosemary Cocktail Syrup (just add your choice of alcohol)	Blueberry, Miso, and White Chocolate Chip Ready to Bake Cookies	Blueberry Almond Butter Bars	Blueberry Polenta Cakes	Blueberry Chunky Granola Spread	Super blue grain-free granola	Frozen Blueberry Skyr
Blueberry / Elderberry THC Tincture	Blueberry-Pecan Brioche Buns	Brain Bar	Blueberry Frosting	Blueberry Hatch Chile Jam	Blueberry Mushroom Jerky (plant based jerky)	Sour Fruit Leather Twists
Blueberry Vermouth	Blueberry and Candied Ginger Kouign Amann	Blueberry Layer Oat Bars	Blueberry Breakfast Salad	Sweet Blueberry Whipped Ricotta Dip/Spread	Blueberry, Nut and Seed Curry Spicem Snack Mix	Blueberry Frozen Banana
Blue Sangria	Blue Cashew Fresh Super Bars	Blueberry Breakfast Balls	Bluberry Feta Turkey Burgers	Blueberry Ginger Compote	Super Tart Better Bluebrry Fruit Rollup Snacks	Blueberry Compound Butters
Blue Is Better Cocktails	Blueberry Alfajores		Blueberries and Grains Salad Starters	Blueberry Herb Demiglace	Blueberry and Yogurt Streusel Pie Pops	
Aromatic Blueberry Bitters Spritz	Blueberry Stroopwafel		Blueberry Lemon Chicken Salad		Blueberry Churro Bites	
Adult Juice Concentrates/ Syrups	Blueberry Functional Spicing Blends		Blueberry & Preserved Lemon Hummus		Blueberry Oat Gushers	
Super juice	Whole Wheat Blueberry Sheet Pan Pancakes		Blueberry Superfood Puddings			
Blueberry Functional Teas	Rye and Blueberry Tartlets					
Blueberry Prebiotic Apple Cider Vinegar Dose	Blueberry, rosemary and grilled lemon foccacia					
	Blueberry 'Cranachan'					
	Blueberry Frangipane Tartlettes					
	Blueberry Pie Crust					
	Blueberry, Spelt, Flax Tortillas					
	Blueberry Bitty Bundts					
	Blueberry Italian Rainbow Cookies					
	Blueberry Mallow "Salami" Slices					

And we prioritized **15** ideas to bring the brief to life in a tasting.

INNOVATION CONCEPTS BY PLATFORM

BEVERAGE

- Blueberry Superfood Smoothie Cubes
- Blueberry Kombucha

BAKERY/ BAKED GOODS/ CONFECTIONARY

- Blueberry Collagen Chocolate Chews
- Blue Cashew Fresh Super Bars
- Blueberry Allspice Rolls

CEREAL & SNACK BARS

- Blueberry Coconut Mochi Snack Bar

PREPARED FOODS

- Dried Blueberry, Almond, & Caperberry Couscous
- Creamy Blue Tamales
- Kids' Turkey & Blueberry Protein Bites
- Blueberry, Balsamic & Ricotta Spread

SAUCES/ MARINADES/ JAMS/ JELLIES

- Super Blue Nut Butters
- Blueberry Miso Sauces
- Blueberry & Preserved Lemon Hummus

SNACKS

- Blueberry Ginger Fruit Rollup Snacks

WILD CARD

- Blueberry Compound Butters

DEVELOPMENT TEAM



Dina Paz
Culinary Director



Rosalyn Darling
Associate Culinary Director



David Berenson
SRG Culinary Council,
Product Development Chef



Rebecca Anderson
SRG Culinary Council,
Product Development Chef



Brittany Kovacevic
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Julia Thompson
Culinex, Culinologist



Brad Walker
Culinex, Culinologist



Brianna Ray
Culinary Specialist, RD

DISTILLATION VOTING GUIDE

Concept Name:_____	Notes	Score
Overall Appeal • Is the product appetizing? • Is it innovative, unique, or compelling? • Does it support current food trends? • Does the blueberry inclusion enhance the product overall?		1 2 3 4 5
Visual Appeal • Does the application have a visual “wow” factor? • Does the product look appetizing? • Is there color/textural variety for visual interest?		1 2 3 4 5
Flavor • Does the product have an appetizing flavor? • Are the flavors balanced? • Is the texture appetizing? • Does the flavor profile match the idea description? • Is it a unique concept for USHBC?		1 2 3 4 5
Operational/Manufacturing Feasibility • What is the cost feasibility of production? • Is specialized/expensive equipment needed for scale-up? • What is the likelihood of manufacturability? • Does it require high volume of blueberries?		1 2 3 4 5
Fit for Target Audience • Does it appeal to target companies? • Does it have cross-over appeal for foodservice establishments? • Does it incorporate on trend ingredients/flavors?		1 2 3 4 5



LET’S TASTE!

TASTING MENU

1. BLUEBERRY SUPERFOOD SMOOTHIE CUBES – David Berenson
2. BLUEBERRY CALM KOMBUCHA – Rosalyn Darling
3. BLUEBERRY COLLAGEN CHOCOLATE CHEWS – Julia Thompson
4. BLUE CASHEW FRESH SUPER BARS – Rebecca Anderson
5. BLUEBERRY ALLSPICE ROLLS – Brad Walker
6. BLUEBERRY COCONUT MOCHI SNACK BAR – Rebecca Anderson
7. BLUEBERRY & PRESERVED LEMON HUMMUS – Dina Paz

BREAK

1. CREAMY BLUE TAMALES – Dina Paz
2. DRIED BLUEBERRY, ALMOND & CAPERBERRY COUSCOUS – Brad Walker
3. TURKEY & BLUEBERRY PROTEIN BITES – Rebecca Anderson
4. BLUEBERRY BALSAMIC & RICOTTA SPREAD - Brad Walker
5. SUPER BLUE NUT BUTTERS – Rebecca Anderson
6. BLUEBERRY APPLE MISO SAUCE – Rosalyn Darling
7. BLUEBERRY GINGER FRUIT ROLLUPS – David Berenson
8. BLUEBERRY COMPOUND BUTTERS – Rosalyn Darling



Blueberry Superfood Smoothie Cubes

// DAVID BERENSON//





INNOVATION PLATFORM

Beverage

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

IQF (Puree, single strength)

DESCRIPTION

Blueberries and superfoods blended and frozen into portion-controlled cubes make creating a delicious nutrient packed smoothie at home a snap. Features organic blueberries, fresh turmeric, MCT oil, chia, a blend of super greens (kale, moringa, wheatgrass and spirulina) plus extra protein and good fats from almonds and hemp hearts. All with no added sugar. Just pop the cubes in a blender with plant based or dairy milk of your choice, spin until smooth and enjoy!

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- Feasibility is straightforward and simple by blending ingredients together and freezing into cubes (or any shape) for portioning.
- Functional ingredients for immunity and antioxidant benefits are a growing trend in the beverage category; makes for an easy entry point for consumers.
- Other benefits can serve for Energy, Calming and Refresh with different blueberry and ingredient pairings.

Blueberry Calm Kombucha

// ROSALYN DARLING//



INNOVATION PLATFORM

Beverage

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

Juice Concentrate

DESCRIPTION

A probiotic-packed, sparkling kombucha made with antioxidant-rich blueberries, calming chamomile, lavender, hops, passionflower, and valerian root.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- Similar to CPG production processes: a master batch of kombucha was made. Blueberry juice concentrate was steeped with botanicals and then strained. Concentrate was added to master kombucha.
- 15% blueberry concentrate, 85% kombucha tea
- Blueberries as a superfood plus the benefits of fermentation equals gut and brain health – clarity, digestion.
- Growth in fermentation among all food and beverage are becoming accepted thanks to cultural diversity and a need for flavor exploration.

Blueberry Collagen Chocolate Chews

// JULIA THOMPSON//



INNOVATION PLATFORM

Bakery/Baked Goods/Confectionary

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

Freeze-dried, Dry Infused, Powder

DESCRIPTION

Truffle-inspired collagen chews with a caramel center and coated in a collagen-rich blueberry and cacao ganache.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- Mix of dark chocolate ganache and caramel chew, includes freeze-dried and dried blueberries for maximum blueberry flavor & presence.
- Coating leverages the blueberry color as a visual contrast with a drizzle of white chocolate
- Collagen supports skin, hair and nails and adding blueberries boosts the functional impact of the product.
- Beauty food, beauty from the inside-out is an on-going trend that goes beyond grocery retail.

Blue Cashew Fresh Super Bars

// REBECCA ANDERSON//



INNOVATION PLATFORM

Bakery/Baked Goods/Confectionary

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

Dry Infused, Juice Concentrate, Powder

DESCRIPTION

Blueberry cashew fresh bar packed with dried blueberries, chopped cashews quinoa crispies and white chocolate chips all in a nut butter base with added almond protein.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- Blueberry juice, powder, concentrate and dried are added into a creamy cashew and white chocolate blend for a fresh, permissibly indulgent anti-oxidant and fiber rich protein bar.
- Quinoa adds fiber and protein to boost the heart-healthy equities of the bar.
- Refrigerated snack bars containing probiotics are perceived as fresh, and contain readily absorbable nutrients for the body.

Blueberry Allspice Rolls

// BRAD WALKER//



INNOVATION PLATFORM

Bakery/Baked Goods/Confectionary

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

Canned In Syrup

DESCRIPTION

This is a cinnamon roll with blueberry jam and allspice in place of cinnamon and sugar. The warm allspice pairs well with the sweet blueberries. This product is somewhere between a cinnamon roll and rugelach. Sold as ready-to-bake dough in a tube.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- The canned berries were a natural choice in this sweet application.
- Citrus notes in the blueberry brighten the flavor profile the compote to stand out from the rich dough.
- Dried blueberries are incorporated into the jam where they partially hydrate for textural optimization.
- Leverages the pairing of blueberries and unique warming spices for an exciting twist on a familiar favorite.

Blueberry Coconut Mochi Snack Bar

// JULIA THOMPSON//



INNOVATION PLATFORM

Cereal & Snack Bars

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

IQF

DESCRIPTION

A pack of chewy, dense, sweet, and nutty snack bar. Mochi gives these bars a very chewy texture that, along with its flavor is unique to the snack bar category.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- The IQF blueberries are perfect for this application. They created a burst of juiciness that goes well with the chew of the bar.
- The blueberry powder provides great color and flavor, making this bar fun and tasty. The blueberry powder dissolves quicky and in easily added to the batter.
- Lime juice is added background note and helps boost the blueberry flavor.
- Globally-inspired snacking is an entry point to exploring new ingredients and textures for experience seekers.
- Rice flour and absence of wheat makes this for gluten-free snacking

Blueberry & Preserved Lemon Hummus

// DINA PAZ//



INNOVATION PLATFORM

Sauces/Marinades/Jams/Jellies

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

Canned in water & Juice

DESCRIPTION

Line of blueberry hummuses with a range of interesting toppings that pair or contrast with the blueberry. Hummus is pulse-based for protein and can be a paired with pita chips for an on-the-go snack play.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- Canned blueberries, chickpeas, preserved lemon, tahini and extra virgin olive oil for a savory blueberry hummus.
- Blueberry color makes the hummus category more exciting and differentiated.
- Protein and fiber rich dip with a blueberry base for a variety of toppings to enhance the nutritional profile.
- Blueberry base is neutral enough to be made either sweet or savory.



BREAK

Blueberry & Sweet Cream Tamales

// DINA PAZ//





INNOVATION PLATFORM

Prepared Foods

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

Canned in Juice

DESCRIPTION

Sweet corn tamales made with heirloom blue corn masa harina and whole blueberries then stuffed with a lightly sweetened cream cheese filling.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- Blue corn masa harina was hydrated with blueberry juice and mixed with whole blueberries, butter, sugar and cinnamon for a dessert play.
- The vibrant blue hue from the blueberries is featured prominently in the masa dough and can work with either white or blue corn.
- The pairing of blueberries with an heirloom varietal of corn makes for an artisanal take on a Mexican classic.
- New dessert in frozen category

Dried Blueberry, Almond, & Caperberry Couscous

// BRAD WALKER//





INNOVATION PLATFORM

Prepared Foods

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

Freeze Dried

DESCRIPTION

Ready to heat meal with blueberries, capers, and North African herbs and spices like Ras el Hanout. This can be a perfect side dish or vegetarian/vegan option.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- Made with freeze-dried blueberries that plump up after adding hot water.
- Blueberries provide a burst of sweetness and tartness in the couscous that pairs with the brininess of the capers. Adding the warming spices elevates the meal and introduces a global flair.
- Healthy accessible convenience on-the-go.
- Fiber rich with the blueberries and nutrient dense with the whole grain couscous

Turkey & Blueberry Protein Bites

// REBECCA ANDERSON//



INNOVATION PLATFORM

Prepared Foods

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

Dry Infused, Juice Concentrate

DESCRIPTION

Mini snacking meatballs with a Blueberry Teriyaki sauce for a protein rich snack or as part of a meal. Blueberries add a touch of sweetness and appeal to adults and kids alike.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- Whole turkey-based meatballs with hydrated dried blueberries delivers a meatball with a tender texture and pairs lean protein with fiber-rich blueberries.
- The blueberry teriyaki sauce is made with blueberry juice concentrate, tamari, mirin, ginger and lightly sweetened with maple syrup for a pop of color and bright umami.
- Fresh, refrigerated snacking and protein on-the-go.

Blueberry, Balsamic, & Ricotta Spread

//BRAD WALKER//



INNOVATION PLATFORM

Prepared Foods

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

IQF

DESCRIPTION

A vibrant sweet & savory Blueberry compote paired with an herb-based ricotta whip spread and topped with chopped pistachios. Great as a dip or as a charcuterie addition.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- Lightly sweet and tangy blueberry compote flavored with balsamic vinegar, savory herbs, black pepper, sugar and honey paired with an herb-based ricotta whip.
- Cheese and fruit pairings are a classic combination, and the acidity and bright flavor notes of the berries enhance the ricotta's creaminess.
- IQF berries work well in this application, as there was no added sweetness that would be present in canned with syrup blueberries.
- Ricotta elevates dipping from traditional sour cream and cream cheese bases.

Super Blue Nut Butters

// REBECCA ANDERSON//





INNOVATION PLATFORM

Sauces/Marinades/Jams/Jellies

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

Puree

DESCRIPTION

A multi serve squeezable pouch of almond nut butter packed with blueberries for use as a toast topper, oatmeal swirl or smoothie boost.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- Blueberry jam is made with blueberry puree, lemon juice and sugar then swirled with a nut butter mixture made from almonds.
- The nut butter also contains hemp hearts, flaxseeds, coconut oil and sweetened with maple syrup.
- The blueberry puree has a robust color and cooked up into a very blueberry forward jam. A little citrus was added to the jam for tart balance.
- Loaded with heart-healthy fats that consumers love to see.

Blueberry Apple Miso Sauce

// ROSALYN DARLING//





INNOVATION PLATFORM

Sauces/Marinades/Jams/Jellies

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

IQF

DESCRIPTION

Ripe blueberries simmered with white miso, green apple, red onion, Dijon mustard, garlic, and black pepper. Blended until smooth for a flavorful sauce.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- IQF blueberries worked perfectly for this sauce application, with the natural pectin helping to thicken the sauce.
- Savory herbs and spices played well with the blueberries' inherent sweet and tart flavors.
- Miso is an emerging ingredient that is becoming more recognizable for consumers as a flavor booster and its umami appeal.
- Sauce can be stored chilled or frozen.
- Blueberry presence can be maximized on the plate by using this sauce as a finishing sauce, but this can also be used as a marinade.

Blueberry Ginger Fruit Rollup Snacks

// DAVID BERENSON//





INNOVATION PLATFORM

Snacks

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

IQF

DESCRIPTION

A young kid's favorite aged up for older kids and adults of all ages with tart blueberry forward flavor and a bright and tangy burst of fresh ginger + a touch of black pepper. Lightly sweetened with lots of natural blueberries and just a touch of honey.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- Made with IQF Blueberries, apple sauce, ginger, lemon, honey and black pepper.
- Blueberries were a natural and paired so well with the bright ginger notes and touch of spicy black pepper.
- When dehydrated the color the blueberry brought was distinctive and not off putting.
- A quick, shelf-stable energy boost for on-the-go nutrition with all-natural sweetness.

Blueberry Compound Butters

// ROSALYN DARLING//



FLAVORS

1. Bulletproof 2. Serrano-Lime 3. Everything Spice

INNOVATION PLATFORM

Wild Card

BLUEBERRY FORMAT

Freeze-dried, Powder

DESCRIPTION

A line of blueberry compound butters for different occasions ranging from breakfast to dessert. Can be used as a spread, finishing butter for proteins/vegetables, hot beverage infusion, and in baked goods.

NOTES (BUILD, OPERATIONAL FEASABILITY, MENU TREND)

- Using chopped freeze-dried blueberries and powder kept the butter smooth while infusing blueberry color and flavor. Using canned blueberries resulted in unappealing veining and separation.
- Bulletproof flavor contains lions' mane as an adaptogen for added wellness to beverages.

TOP TAKEAWAYS

NATURALLY BALANCED SWEETNESS & TARTNESS

- The balance of sweetness and tartness in the blueberries enhance a broad range of ingredients.
- Mixing dried and freeze-dried blueberries is a great way to get shelf stable blueberry products with a balanced flavor profile.
- Blueberries are a natural go-to ingredient for their nutrition, texture, color and flavor.

SUPERFOOD POWER

- Blueberries thoughtfully paired with botanicals, herbs and the right spices make for a functional wellness powerhouse.

DEEP BLUE VISUAL APPEAL

- Blueberry color holds well in numerous applications without oxidizing.

FLAVOR & TEXTURE VERSATILITY

- The blueberries are a great foil for the richness of fats, in addition to being a unique vehicle for savory herbal flavors.
- Blueberries flex across both sweet and savory culinary applications.
- Blueberries can elevate the texture through its different forms (i.e.. dry infused for a soft chew or freeze-dried for a light crunch)





DISCUSSION PANEL

DISSCUSSION PANEL

- Overall, what were the biggest surprises in working with this product?
- What worked well? What does this product excel at? How is it advantaged vs. other fruits?
- What were the biggest challenges/barriers you had to overcome? How did you overcome them?
- What/where do you think the biggest opportunity lies for a product like this?



DISTILLATION VOTING GUIDE

Concept Name:_____	Notes	Score
Overall Appeal • Is the product appetizing? • Is it innovative, unique, or compelling? • Does it support current food trends? • Does the blueberry inclusion enhance the product overall?		1 2 3 4 5
Visual Appeal • Does the application have a visual “wow” factor? • Does the product look appetizing? • Is there color/textural variety for visual interest?		1 2 3 4 5
Flavor • Does the product have an appetizing flavor? • Are the flavors balanced? • Is the texture appetizing? • Does the flavor profile match the idea description? • Is it a unique concept for USHBC?		1 2 3 4 5
Operational/Manufacturing Feasibility • What is the cost feasibility of production? • Is specialized/expensive equipment needed for scale-up? • What is the likelihood of manufacturability? • Does it require high volume of blueberries?		1 2 3 4 5
Fit for Target Audience • Does it appeal to target companies? • Does it have cross-over appeal for foodservice establishments? • Does it incorporate on trend ingredients/flavors?		1 2 3 4 5







FINAL DELIVERABLES

- Formalized Recipes
- Recipe Reference Photos
- Selection of 10-12 products to photograph

THANK YOU

SRG +